

SERVICE ANIMAL ACCESS NOTICE

To Business Owners, Managers, and Security Personnel:

This dog, **[Insert Name of Dog/Animal Here]**, is a legally recognized Service Animal under the **Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act (AODA)** and the **Ontario Human Rights Code (OHRC)**.

Under provincial law, [obligated organizations](#) (**O. Reg. 165/16 s. 80.45 (2)**) are required to allow persons with disabilities to be accompanied by their Service Animal in all areas open to the public. A Medical Letter from a [Regulated Health Professional](#) (**O. Reg. 165/16 s. 80.45 (4)b**) is the official documentation that satisfies this legal requirement.

Summary of Ontario Legal Framework:

- [Identification & Documentation](#): Service animals are **not** legally required to wear a vest or harness. Under **O. Reg. 165/16, s. 80.45 (4)a**, a Medical Letter from a Regulated Health Professional is the definitive and sole proof required.
- [General Public Access](#): Per **O. Reg. 165/16, s. 80.47 (2)**, obligated organizations shall ensure that a person with a disability is permitted to enter the premises with their service animal and keep the animal with them.
- [Food Establishments](#): Under the **Health Protection and Promotion Act (O. Reg. 493/17, s. 14)**, service animals are expressly exempt from rules prohibiting animals in areas where food is served, sold, or offered for sale.
- [Privacy Rights](#): The **Ontario Human Rights Code** prohibits businesses from demanding disclosure of a person's medical diagnosis or proof of the animal's training. (*Allarie v. Rouble, 2010 HRTO 61*).

Thank you for [ensuring your staff is aware of these guidelines](#) (**O. Reg. 165/16 s. 80.49 (1)**) to maintain compliance with Ontario's accessibility and human rights laws.